



“Every generation needs a revolution”

PRIYANKA CHOPRA ACTOR

As an Indian actor, I believe I stand for glamour and cinema, but I also do stand for being a thinking youth of today. I feel extremely empowered by the opportunity given to me. I won the Miss World pageant when I was 17. I had a platform to express my thoughts, my views, my ideas and I had generous people who gave me importance and listened to me. I feel extremely empowered by being able to do that today. I take my job as a young celebrity very seriously. I feel that I have a certain social responsibility towards the things I do and the things that I say. And being a celebrity I may be able to bring about a change in the way people think. I have a million things and a hundred ideas that I feel like talking about, especially about the topic today.

There's no escaping that the younger generation today has woken up to its responsibilities of helping India realise its full potential. We are going out there and saying that we are proud to be Indians. Someone really wise said that change is the most constant thing in life. I have always believed that. I think that can be felt by the youth today. We are seeking change and questioning it.

Why? Because over the past few years, we have had a certain fire-in-the-belly attitude. We want to make things happen. We want to get out there and change the world. It's actually sunk in that we can be at par with the best in the world. We don't turn around and say that they are better than us. If I want it bad enough, I can and I will make it happen. Not for ourselves, but also for our country. Change is a little more rapid right now. When 26/11 happened, we were angry. There were 50,000 people on the streets. Delhi shook, governments shook because they did not expect the anger that the youth showed. Every generation needs a revolution and I think our revolution has started. I saw an advertisement for Apple computers. "Here's to the crazy ones, the misfits, the rebels, the troublemakers, the ones who have no respect for status quo. You can disagree with them but the only thing you can't do is ignore them. Because they push the human race forward and while some may see them as crazy ones. We see genius."

People who are crazy enough to think that they can change the world are the ones that do. I feel the generation of today is a little crazy and can change the world. We just have to have people believe in us.

For full speech and discussion, click to:
www.indiatodayconclave.in/youth



DISCUSSION

Q. Can anyone in the Congress progress without saying "Jai ho" to one Gandhi or the other and would you have been a minister in the Cabinet without your surname?

Prasada: You are right. Your surname matters and the Gandhi name matters but you are tested every five years. So, you have to perform and the day you are not performing, you are out.

Q. My generation is being called self-obsessed, disillusioned. How are we supposed to rise if our efforts have been undermined even before we have begun?

Chopra: Well, I have to agree

with you. If you are cynical towards what we can do, how will we ever find that drive? I would like to reiterate that we are discussing the fact that youth can actually drive change and most people are agreeing on that front. It will require some time, but I think it will happen.

Q. What change will you personally drive?

Prasada: What gave me the satisfaction and the go was that I could make a difference to the lives of people in my constituency. You are helping them get a job, you are helping a sick person reach the hospital.

Q. You, being the young gen-

eration, are the future of the nation. My question is: Where is the obstacle for this change?

Ruia: I started pretty early, at the age of 15 or 16. The initial reaction was that 'he is young'. It's a game of few years and you will come around and start thinking the way everybody else thinks. But I think if we put in the hard work, if we have commitment and if once the elder generation gets the impression that yes, he has the stability to take on more responsibility, doors open very fast. Initially, for the first five to seven years, I had the same questions. You keep talking, you keep having these great ideas and frankly no one

is listening, but once I got to my early 20s, I didn't face that problem at all.

Q. Do you see any limitations in the ideology of youth culture in India?

Bindra: The most important thing is that the youth has an audacity of imagination to aspire to reach unachievable heights and they have the innovation to come through and the innovation to find new ways. The most important thing is that they also have the courage to make mistakes and to bounce back. So I think they just need nurturing and that for me is the most important thing.